

BY A BLINK

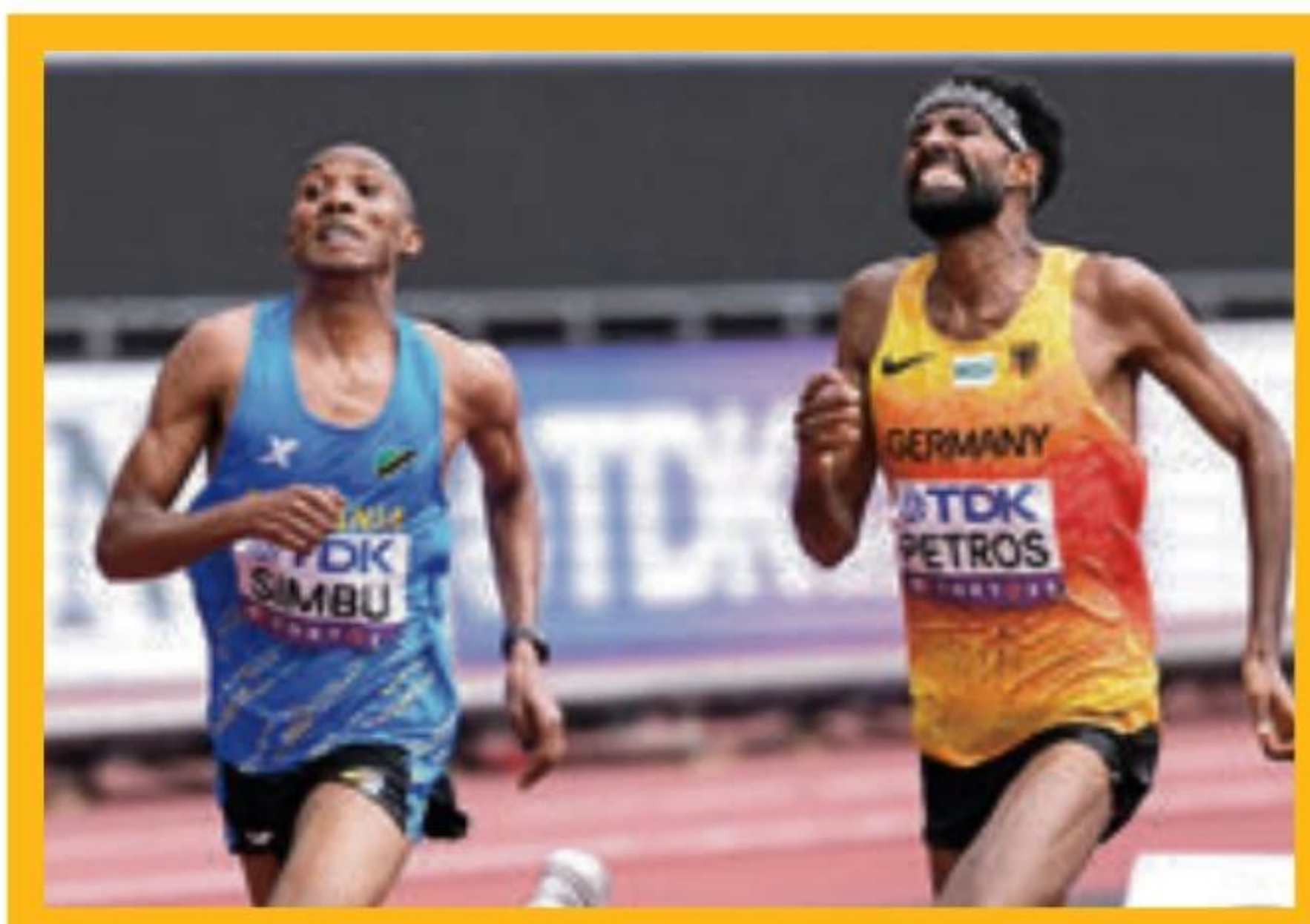
Tanzania's Alphonse Simbu and Germany's Amanuel Petros produced a finish for the ages in the men's marathon at the World Athletics Championships in Tokyo, separated only by a photo finish after 26.2 gruelling miles.

Petros held a slender lead as the race entered its final stages at the Tokyo National Stadium. The German, bidding to become his country's first world champion in marathon, was still marginally ahead as the pair rounded the final bend and surged onto the home straight.

But Simbu had kept something in reserve. Over the final 30 metres, the Tanzanian unleashed a late burst, closing the gap in a blur. Both runners stopped the clock at 2:09:48, with Petros throwing himself across the line in a desperate lunge.

After more than two hours of running, the championship was decided by the narrowest of margins. A photo finish confirmed Simbu as the winner, edging Petros by just 0.03 seconds. The margin of victory was finer than even the men's and women's 100m finals at the Championships.

Simbu, who had claimed bronze in the marathon at the 2017 World Championships, went one better this time, becoming the first Tanzanian athlete to win a world title.



TABLES TURNED

Australia has long been India's toughest opponent in world cricket. Chasing 339 in a World Cup semifinal only heightened that challenge.

In 2025, however, the Indian women produced a performance for the ages, pulling off a world-record run chase to beat defending champion Australia by five wickets in the ODI World Cup semifinal.

Australia, the world No. 1 side then, piled up 338 after winning the toss. Phoebe Litchfield's 119 off 93 balls set the tone, with Elysse Perry (77) and Ashleigh Gardner (63) adding momentum late in the innings.

There was added context. Earlier in the tournament, Australia had chased down 330 against India, a record that made this semifinal a chance for redemption.

India's reply began unsteadily, with Shafali Verma and Smriti Mandhana falling early. The chase was rebuilt by Jemimah Rodrigues and captain Harmanpreet Kaur, whose 167-run stand, the highest against Australia in a Women's World Cup, carried India beyond 250.

Harmanpreet fell for 89, but a dropped catch of Jemimah on 83 proved costly for Australia. She went on to score a career-best 127 off 134 balls, her maiden World Cup century, and guided India to a landmark victory.

